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Viel Spaß beim üben,

Ömer

1. Englisch Klausur 16.09.2026

USA – Presidential Speeches

Outline

An **outline** is a **short, objective summary** of the **most important information** from a text/material, usually **structured according to a specific question or aspect**.

Language

- simple present
- **objective** and **factual** writing style
- **DO NOT** give your **opinion**
- Write a **text** not bullet points

Introduction

- Title
- Text type
- Author
- Date and place of publication
- **Theme** (What is the text about?)

Main Part

- Summarize the points in the text in a logical order.
- Begin with the main point or central theme.
- Then describe the important sub-points and how they relate to one another.
- Clearly explain the structure of the text.
- Answer the W-Questions (What, Why, When, Who, How)

Summary

A summary is for someone who has not read a text and needs to know the essence of what it is about. It should be no longer than 1/3 of the source text.

Before Writing

- Read the text carefully and highlight key words and key sentences
- Divide the text up into parts or subsections
- Find an appropriate sentence or keywords to summarize each subsection

Introduction

- The introductory sentence of the summary should include:
 - the author
 - the title
 - type of text
 - the place & date of publication
 - the main idea & topic

Main Part

- Focus on the essentials/on basic facts

Don't include irrelevant details

- Use simple present

Don't use present progressive

- Use your own words

Don't use quotations or direct speech

- Use **formal language**

Don't give personal opinion

Don't start analyzing the text

→ ~~giving evidence or starting to explain~~

Don't try to create suspense

- Use **connectives** to link your sentences

Analysis

An analysis is used to introduce and **prove a claim** using **evidence** from the source text.

Introduction

- (if no summary beforehand) The introductory sentence of the analysis should include:
 - the author
 - the title
 - type of text
 - the place & date of publication
 - the main idea & topic
- The introduction should also contain a **central claim** on what is expected to be found in the analysis, *e.g. what the author's overall aim and strategy is*

Main Part

- Should prove the **central claim** in detail
- Should provide **textual evidence**, *e. g.: examples of linguistic devices and strategies* and should explain their function and the **desired effect**
- Should be structured into **multiple paragraphs**, each one focusing on **supporting a certain aspect of the main claim** with **evidence**

Example structure for a paragraph in the Main Part

(PEARL Model):

1. Point	• Introduce the point you are going to make in this paragraph.
2. Evidence	• Supply evidence from the text to support your point by quoting or paraphrasing.
3. Analysis	• Explain how this evidence supports your point. Sometimes quotes also need a bit of context.
4. (Repeat)	• If you can give additional evidence for this point, repeat steps 2 und 3.
5. Link	• If possible, write a transition sentence to link this paragraph to the next.

Conclusion

- Should **summarize the results** of the analysis
- Should **refer back to the central claim** and the **task**

Language

- Use varied choice of words
- Use various connectives and linking words
- Use correct spelling, punctuation and grammar
- Use the present tense
- Use formal and neutral language
- Don't use short forms

Linguistic Devices for Analysis Purposes

Stylistic Devices

Stylistic Device	Definition	Purpose / Effect
Alliteration	a combination of words that start with the same letter or sound to make the phrase more memorable (e.g. <i>I murder hate by field or flood</i>)	to make a certain point more memorable, to intensify a certain point, to create a sense of sharpness
Anaphora	the repetition of identical words or phrases at the beginning of a sentences (e.g. <i>I have a dream ..., I have a dream ...</i>)	to put emphasis on sth., to convince the listener
Antithesis	Contrast of opposing words, phrases, views or ideas to highlight differences	To emphasize contrast between two things
Enumeration	Listing items to show range or variety (e.g. <i>Look at the red, grey, blue and yellow lights</i>)	To show scale, diversity, or give an overview
Hyperbole (Exaggeration)	Deliberate exaggeration (e.g. <i>a sea of thousand tears</i>)	To dramatize and create vivid imagery
Metaphor	Direct comparison without "like" or "as" (e.g. <i>My gap year was a long, beautiful dream</i>)	To create strong imagery and deepen understanding
Parallelism	Repetition of sentence structure (e.g. <i>O death, where is your victory? O death, where is your sting?</i>)	To emphasize ideas and create rhythm
Personification	Giving human qualities to objects or ideas (e.g. <i>a smiling moon</i>)	To make descriptions more vivid and engaging
Repetition	Repeating words or phrases (e.g. <i>I have fought against white domination and I have fought against black domination</i>)	To emphasize key ideas and grab attention
Rhetorical Question	Question with no expected answer (e.g. <i>Isn't that great?</i>)	To engage and persuade the audience
Simile	Comparison using "like" or "as" (e.g. <i>she was as hungry as a lion</i>)	To create clear and relatable comparisons

Rhetorical Strategies

Strategy	Definition (with Example)	Possible Effect
Quoting experts and authorities	e.g. scientists, politicians	to back up one's statements and make them and the author seem more reliable and credible
Inclusive language	specify use of pronouns (e.g. unifying 3rd person plural we/us/our); use of pronoun "I" to show a personal reference to a certain topic	to include the audience and give them a feeling of belonging
Personal statements	including personal statements of people affected by the issue at hand	to add a personal touch, to make it easier for the reader to identify with a story
Metaphorical language	words or phrases that trigger specific associations and create an image in the reader's mind	—
Emotive language	e.g. lots of adjectives	to evoke emotions, to cause an audience to react in a particular way
Informal language	—	to create a particular atmosphere, to create a bond with the reader/listener
Statistics	referring to statistics and giving exact numbers	to show that one has very detailed knowledge of a topic and to make one's claims appear grounded in facts
Humour and irony	e.g. by making fun of a situation, commenting humorously on something	to ridicule unacceptable/strange/... behaviour, to make an article more light-hearted and entertaining
Making claims	e.g. <i>No one can deny that ..., without a doubt ..., it is no surprise that ...</i>	to present opinions as facts or as points that are beyond criticism
Word field	—	to create a certain image

Choice of Words

Device	Possible Effect
Using comparatives and superlatives	to exaggerate points or draw attention to extremes to appeal to the readers' emotions, to make them think positively/critically or something
using strong or emotive words (e.g. heartbroken, bloodbath, to worship)	
negatively connoted words i.e. words that imply negative emotions or associations	
positively connoted words i.e. words that imply positive emotions or associations	
informal and vulgar expressions	

Register

Degree of formality	Possible effect
formal (e.g. <i>I must say I'm not particularly fond of this films</i>)	to create a feeling of belonging or distance to a certain group
neutral (e.g. <i>I never liked his films</i>)	
informal	
colloquial	to appeal to the readers' emotions
familiar (e.g. <i>God, I can't stand his films</i>)	
intimate	

Vocabulary List for Presidential Speeches

Word/Phrase	Meaning
inauguration	The formal ceremony in which a newly elected president takes office
Inaugural address	A speech given by a president at their inauguration, usually outlining vision for the country
Victory speech	A speech given after winning an election, usually thanking supporters and celebrating the result
Concession speech	A speech given by a candidate who has lost an election formally accepting the result
State of the Union address	An annual speech in which the US president reports on the country's situation and presents political goals
Presidential address	A formal speech given by a president to the public
Term in office	The period during which a person serves as president
Incumbent	The person currently holding a political office
Presidency	The position or period of being president
Administration	The president and the people who work with them to run the government
Constituents	The people represented by an elected politician
Electorate	All the people who are entitled to vote in an election

Partisan	Strongly supporting one political party or side
Campaign trail	The series of places and events a politician visits while campaigning
Platform	A political party's or candidate's stated set of policies and goals
Mandate	The authority a politician claims to have received from voters to carry out their policies
Pledge	A serious promise, especially a political one
Prosperity	A state of being successful, wealthy and economically strong
Adversity	A difficult or challenging situation
Divisiveness	The quality of causing disagreement or separation between people
Polarization	The process by which people become divided into strongly opposing groups
Unity	The state of being united and working together
Common ground	Shared beliefs, interests or ideas between people who disagree
Heritage	The traditions, history and cultural values passed through generations
Legacy	The lasting impact or achievements a person leaves behind
Democratic values	Principles such as freedom, equality, political participation and the rule of law
The rule of law	The principle that everyone, including the government, must follow the law
Civil liberties	Basic individual freedoms protected by law
National security	The protection of a country from threats to its safety and interests
Foreign policy	Government policy concerning issues with other countries
Domestic policy	Government policy concerning issues within the country
Allies	Countries that cooperate and support each other, especially in political or military matters
Rival/adversary	A person, group or country competing/in conflict with another

Diplomacy	The management of relations between countries through negotiation
Commitment	A strong promise or dedication to a particular cause or goal